

it permanent either by clicking on a new layer or by clicking on the anchor layer icons. When you click on the new layer while the pasted layer is selected, the pasted layer will be assigned a new layer and it will be made permanent. But if you click on the anchor layer, the pasted layer will be merged into the background of the image giving you little freedom for editing. Figure 4 demonstrates how pasted layers work.

Now we shall delve into moving a layer. To get started, create a background or open a wallpaper with the GIMP. Once done, grab the Text tool [A] from the toolbox and type something. Do note that whenever you try to edit/move/modify a layer, ensure the desired layer is selected; else the effect will be applied in the wrong section of the image.

Select the text layer and grab the Move tool from the toolbox or press 'm'. Notice the cursor change when you take it outside or inside the selected text layer. Figure 5 will give you a glimpse of the cursor change when taking it away or nearer the active layer region. Once you get the four-directional arrow key at the foot of the cursor, left click and while holding down the left button, move it wherever you want.

I'm sure you'll understand that layer management is very essential if you are working with more layers. It's actually a nice habit if you get used to it.

The GIMP automatically gives each layer a name so that it's easy to distinguish when working with a high number of layers, especially while creating wallpapers. Just double click on a layer name and you can edit the layer's default name. Figure 6 illustrates this feature.

Every layer has its own editing options, though some of them can be achieved easily. To gain access to a layer's editing options, just right click on the layer and an extra window will pop up, giving you easy

access to all the editing options, as listed in Figure 7.

- **Edit Layer Attributes:** This option is basically the same as layer management. Selecting it will reveal a box where you can enter a new name to the layer. I always default to the double-click feature as stated above.
- **New Layer:** This option creates a new layer. This is similar to the icon present in the layer box.
- **New Layer from visible:** This option creates a new layer that contains all the elements of the currently visible layers, merged into one.
- **Duplicate/Anchor/Delete Layer:** These options have similar functions to their icon counterparts. Nothing fancy here.
- **Merge Down:** This option merges the currently selected layer with the next visible layer below. Transparency will be sustained, though the active layer modes will be retained.
- **Layer Boundary Size:** Every layer has its boundary, which is visible when you select a layer, making it easier for you to differentiate it from those not selected. The size can be increased or decreased at will. This option does just that—you can easily increase/decrease the size. Please note that the image/layer will remain intact; the only thing that will change is its boundary.
- **Layer to Image Size:** All this tool does is resize the layer boundary to the image size.
- **Scale Layer:** It is the same as resizing an image but will only be applied to the selected layer.
- **Add Layer Mask:** This adds a layer mask to the selected layer. This option lets you choose the type of mask you want to apply on the particular layer.
- **Apply/Delete Layer Mask:** The former appends the changes done in the mask to the host layer. Delete layer mask deletes


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